

Meoncross School History Department

Department Development Plan (DDP) 2026–2027

OPERATIONAL MASTER

SUBJECT

History

SUBJECT LEADER

Benjamin Lovett (Head of History)

ACADEMIC YEAR

2026–2027

ALIGNMENT

Meoncross SIP 2026

OBJECTIVE	ACTIONS (HOW YOU WILL ACHIEVE THE OBJECTIVE)	SUCCESS CRITERIA & EVIDENCE	DATES	OWNER
SUBJECT CORE PRIORITY Academic Achievement (GCSE) Secure strong student attainment and confidence in Edexcel GCSE History (Papers 1, 2, and 3) while keeping marking manageable through standardized question stamps and clear model answers.	1. Embed revised Edexcel exam question formats into teaching: 4-mark Consequence stamps (PEE), 8-mark Narrative flowcharts, and 8-mark Importance frameworks in Conflict in the Middle East and Elizabethan England. 2. Use low-stakes recall quizzes (Do Nows and Flashcard Vault) at the start of lessons to reinforce core knowledge and retention.	• Consistent student completion of structured exam practice in workbooks. • Revised Edexcel exam question frameworks (4-mark Consequence, 8-mark Narrative, 8-mark Importance) embedded in KS4 lessons.	Ongoing 2026–27	BL
SIP STRATEGIC AIM 2 Aspirational Curriculum Deliver a sequenced, chronologically secure 5-year curriculum that links national and global history with local Hampshire context (Funtley Ironworks, Portsmouth Dockyard, and Stubbington).	1. Teach a coherent 5-year curriculum connecting local coastal heritage to national and international events. 2. Use pure paragraph indexing [Act.Paragraph] in lesson materials to provide pupils with clear chronological structure and cognitive signposting.	• Department Schemes of Work published and followed across all year groups. • Pupils demonstrate secure chronological understanding and positive engagement with local historical context.	Ongoing 2026–27	BL
SIP STRATEGIC AIM 2 & 4 Co-Curriculum & Clubs Broaden pupil horizons and foster historical curiosity, strategic thinking, and leadership through extra-curricular activities and experiential field trips.	1. Run the weekly Meoncross Chess Club, encouraging house participation, ladder progression, and tactical skill. 2. Plan and deliver the biannual GCSE Ypres Battlefield Tour to support Paper 1 Western Front depth study. 3. Support interested pupils in submitting research entries to the annual Hampshire Archives Local History Competition.	• Regular pupil attendance and house engagement at Chess Club. • Successful delivery of the 2026 GCSE Ypres Battlefield Tour.	Ongoing 2026–27	BL

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Priorities 4–5: Adaptive Teaching & SMSC / British Values

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SIP STRATEGIC AIM 1 & 2 Adaptive Teaching & SEND Ensure all SEND and lower-attaining pupils access challenging historical content effectively through pre-formatted dual coding and 3-tier scaffolding, with zero extra paper planning.	1. Use printed workbooks paired with digital resources to support SEND pupils with 3-tier scaffolding (Bronze starters, Silver connectives, Gold evaluation). 2. Utilize digital accessibility tools (built-in SEN mode, adjustable read-aloud speed, visual dual coding) to offload working memory.	• SEND pupils access curriculum tasks successfully with appropriate scaffolding. • Teacher planning workload minimized through standardized, pre-formatted resources.	Embedded in practice	BL
SIP STRATEGIC AIM 3 SMSC & British Values Systematically explore British Values, democracy, and ethical issues naturally through the curriculum, recording key departmental touchpoints on Gridmaker.	1. Address British Values, democracy, and moral dilemmas through curriculum topics (e.g. Peasants' Revolt 1381, Chartism, civil rights, and public health ethics). 2. Log departmental curriculum touchpoints on the school's Gridmaker system on an ongoing basis as required by school policy.	• Key topics recorded on Gridmaker as required for whole-school auditing. • Pupils engage thoughtfully with ethical and moral questions during classroom discussions.	Termly as needed	BL

1. Cognitive Offloading & Workload

Printed workbooks paired with the History Hub app pre-format scaffolding and dual coding once, cutting weekly teacher preparation and standardizing expectations.

2. Meaningful Local History

Hampshire connections (Funtley Ironworks, Portsmouth Royal Dockyard, Stubbington war memorials) ground national history in pupils' lived coastal environment.

3. Straightforward Evidence

GCSE exam question stamps provide structured pupil writing; SMSC touchpoints are recorded directly on Gridmaker without extra paperwork.